FOREIGN AFFAIRS | Diplomacy

GLOBAL GPS: War. Markets. Mega power shifts. And India's new voice in the world

S. JAISHANKAR *Union Minister of External Affairs*

ON THE HIGH TABLE

External affairs minister Subrahmanyam Jaishankar is at the helm of affairs in the year of India's presidency of the G20 and oversaw the successful meeting of G20 finance and foreign ministers. However, the Ukraine conflict makes it challenging to get G20 countries to agree on a common framework. As such, one of his main endeavours is to bring back focus on the original G20 mandate: global development and growth. Jaishankar also points out that for the first time, India consulted much of the world not represented at the summit. At the Voice of Global South summit in January, India asked 125 nations about their requirements that needed to be tabled at the G20.

Jaishankar believes that India-China ties cannot return to normality unless all outstanding issues at the Line of Actual Control (LAC) are resolved. For him, bilateral ties had entered a "challenging and abnormal phase" due to the stand-off in Ladakh and Arunachal Pradesh. He said the situation on the border with China is very fragile due to the large deployment of troops by both sides. Taking on

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- It's a challenging and abnormal phase in India's ties with China
- The situation remains "fragile" and "dangerous" on the LAC as per military assessment
- China has been told that it can't violate agreements and expect the relationship to continue like nothing happened
- India's priority would be to get back the G20 to its original mandate of global development and growth
- At the Voice of Global South Summit in January, PM Modi asked 125 nations about their expectations from the G20 Summit

